

Also known as: Debug arena, viva, debug viva, code explanation test, debugging test

Audience: candidate

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Mock Debug — explain and debug, out loud

1. What this is

Mock Debug shows you something — a piece of code with a problem in it, a diagram, or a real-world scenario — and asks you to **explain it out loud**. You record a spoken answer. It is scored on whether you understood the concept, how well you reasoned, how accurately you read what was in front of you, and how clearly you explained it.

It is the closest thing on the platform to a technical viva. It follows your **branch and subject**, working through a curriculum in order rather than giving you random questions.

2. Who can use it

Every candidate, on both plans. Not a PRO-only feature.

3. Names and terms

A user might say	Meaning
viva, debug viva	Mock Debug
stream, branch	your engineering branch (e.g. IT, CS)
subject	the subject within your branch
set	one day's group of questions
artifact	the code, image or scenario you are asked about

4. How it works, step by step

1. Open **Mock Debug** and pick your **stream** and **subject**.
2. You get a set of questions. Each one shows you one of: - **code** — a snippet with a bug, a logic error, a performance problem or an edge case it fails; - **an image** — a diagram or illustration of a concept; - **a scenario** — a described situation to reason about. Most also come with a short spoken explanation you can listen to.
3. **Record your answer by speaking**. Explain what you see, what is wrong, why, and what you would do about it.
4. You can skip a question, or abandon the attempt, at any point.

5. Finish. Your answers are transcribed and scored in the background.
6. Your report appears under **Report**, with per-question scores and a written summary.

The questions follow your curriculum in order. You start at the beginning of your subject and progress through each topic at three increasing difficulty levels before moving to the next topic. Come back tomorrow and you continue from where you stopped — you do not get a random set.

5. Rules, limits and timings

Rule	Basic	PRO
Attempts per week	3	4

- A microphone is required.
- You progress **in sequence** through your subject's topics. Your position is remembered between attempts.
- Questions are reused across candidates on the same topic and difficulty, so two students on the same subject may see the same set.
- Once your weekly limit is reached, wait for the week to roll over or use an assessment credit.

6. How scoring works

Each answer is scored **0 to 10** on four things:

Dimension	What it measures
Conceptual clarity	Do you actually understand the underlying concept?
Reasoning depth	Is your analysis thorough, or surface-level?
Artifact interpretation	Did you correctly read the code, image or scenario in front of you?
Communication precision	Is your explanation clear and well structured?

Your score for a question is the **average of those four**. Your overall score is the average across all the questions you answered.

What this means in practice: naming the bug correctly but not explaining why it happens scores well on interpretation and poorly on reasoning depth. Rambling towards a right answer costs you communication precision. The highest scores go to answers that identify the problem, explain the mechanism, and say it clearly.

7. What you get afterwards

- **An overall score**, and how many of your answers were accepted.
- **Per-question scores** across the four dimensions.
- **Strengths and observations** — what you did consistently well and what recurred.
- **A performance summary** of four to six sentences in plain language.

8. When things go wrong

"My recording did not capture anything"

Check that your browser has microphone permission and that no other app (Zoom, Meet, Teams) is holding the microphone. A question with no audio scores as unanswered.

"I got the answer right but scored low"

Four things are scored, and being right is only part of one of them. An answer that identifies the bug but does not explain *why* it happens, or that is hard to follow, loses marks on reasoning depth and communication precision. Explain your reasoning out loud, in order.

"The questions are too easy / too hard"

You progress through your subject in sequence, at three difficulty steps per topic. If everything feels easy you are early in a topic; keep going and it deepens. If it feels too hard, you have reached the advanced step of that topic.

"I want different questions"

Change your subject. Within a subject the progression is fixed and sequential by design — it follows the curriculum.

"I got the same questions as my classmate"

Expected. Question sets are shared across candidates working on the same topic and difficulty.

"My report is not ready"

Speech has to be transcribed and scored, so Debug reports take longer than multiple-choice ones. You get a notification when it is ready.

"I abandoned an attempt — does it count?"

An abandoned attempt still counts against your weekly limit. Finish attempts you start.

9. Common questions

Do I have to speak, or can I type? You have to speak. It is a spoken assessment — communication precision is one of the four scored dimensions.

How long are the answers meant to be? Long enough to identify the problem, explain the mechanism and say what you would do. A single sentence will not score well; neither will three minutes of circling.

Can I listen to the question again? Where a question has an audio explanation, you can play it. The code, image or scenario stays on screen.

Can I skip a question? Yes. It is scored as unanswered and lowers your overall average.

Does it matter which subject I pick? Yes — the questions come from that subject's curriculum, and your progress is tracked per subject.

Do I need to be fluent in English? You need to be understandable. Communication precision is scored, but this is a technical viva, not an English test — for English specifically, use `30-svar-spoken-english.md`.

Will I see my position in the curriculum? Your progress is tracked and you continue from where you left off each time.

10. What this does not do

- It does not let you type your answer.
- It does not adapt difficulty to your performance the way SVAR and Aptitude do — it follows the curriculum in fixed order.
- It does not let you choose individual topics; you choose a subject and progress through it.
- It does not test English proficiency as such.

11. When to contact support

- Recordings consistently capturing nothing despite microphone permission being granted.
- An attempt consumed with no report produced.
- Your curriculum progress resetting unexpectedly.